RB-105 Card authorisation gateway

Service

card-auth forwards card authorisations from merchants to the acquirer and returns approve or decline. Merchants wait on it at checkout, so its latency is the customer's latency.

Alert: CardAuthLatencyHigh

Fires when p99 authorisation latency is above 1.5 seconds for 5 minutes. Check the acquirer panel first: most slowness comes from the acquirer, not from card-auth.

Error codes

AUTH-503 means the acquirer did not answer in time and the payment was declined as a timeout. AUTH-429 means a merchant passed its rate limit. AUTH-402 is a decline from the issuing bank and needs no action from us.

Acquirer failover

If the primary acquirer times out on more than 5% of authorisations, switch to the backup acquirer with authctl route --acquirer backup. The backup costs 0.1 percentage points more per payment, so switch back within a day.

Circuit breaker

card-auth opens its circuit breaker after 50 timeouts in a minute and declines fast instead of waiting. A declined payment can be retried by the shopper; a hung checkout is abandoned.